

— A PILOT PROPOSAL FOR [SCHOOL]

The AI-Native Operator Programme

A twelve-week course that teaches [School]'s students to operate AI: to take real work, automate it with the right human oversight, and hand it over running. We propose a pilot cohort of **20 to 25 students** in [Term, 2026].

— WHY NOW

A new skill is being hired for, and the work itself now runs on it.

71%

of leaders would rather hire a candidate **with** AI skills than a more experienced one without.

56%

wage premium for AI-skilled workers in the same role, up from 25% a year earlier.

30%

of employees already work alongside AI agents, up from 13% a year earlier.

Microsoft now calls running several agents across a workflow **Orchestrator**, one of four standard patterns of work. Operating and orchestrating AI is the skill, and it is what this course teaches.

Microsoft and LinkedIn 2024 • PwC Global AI Jobs Barometer 2025 • BCG AI at Work 2026 • Microsoft Work Trend Index 2026

— KENYA'S MOMENT

A national tailwind, and an unforgiving arithmetic.

THE TAILWIND

65th of 195, up 25 places, second in Africa

Government AI Readiness Index 2025. The index measures government readiness, not talent.

Kenya has made AI a national priority, and its readiness is climbing faster than anywhere else on the continent. The ambition is set. The bottleneck now is people who can do the work.

Oxford Insights Government AI Readiness Index 2025

THE ARITHMETIC

Young Kenyans turning 18 each year **≈1M**

Total formal wage jobs in the economy **3.3M**

Of 882,100 jobs created in 2025, **716,800** were informal. Strong credentials still matter. They no longer guarantee a trajectory on their own.

AFP, Jul 2025 · KNBS Economic Survey 2026 via Capital FM, Apr 2026

— THE STRATEGIC POSITION

Train students to operate AI, and they enter one tier up.

AI is automating the entry rung of knowledge work, the level most graduates start on. Students who can direct AI do not compete for that rung. They sit above it, deciding what the work should be and checking that it was done. That is **where the work is going, not where it is leaving.**

These students already reach the world's most selective universities. The Equity Leaders Program alone sent 128 scholars to universities in 20 countries in 2025, 16 of them to the Ivy League. Twelve weeks of operator capability turns that trajectory into a position almost no graduate, anywhere, can yet claim.

Equity Group Holdings, Aug 2025 (company-reported)

— WHAT AN AI-NATIVE OPERATOR IS

A graduate of this course starts a first job. The team says: **here is how we do this today.**

By midweek she has sat with the person who does the work, mapped it step by step, and found the two steps that consume hours, and the one step where judgment matters too much to automate.

By Friday she has built a working automation, with an **approval gate where the owner stays in control**, and can show the time it saves, measured rather than guessed.

She explains it in plain language. **The team keeps using it after she moves on.**

— THE OUTCOME THIS COURSE CONTRACTS TO DELIVER

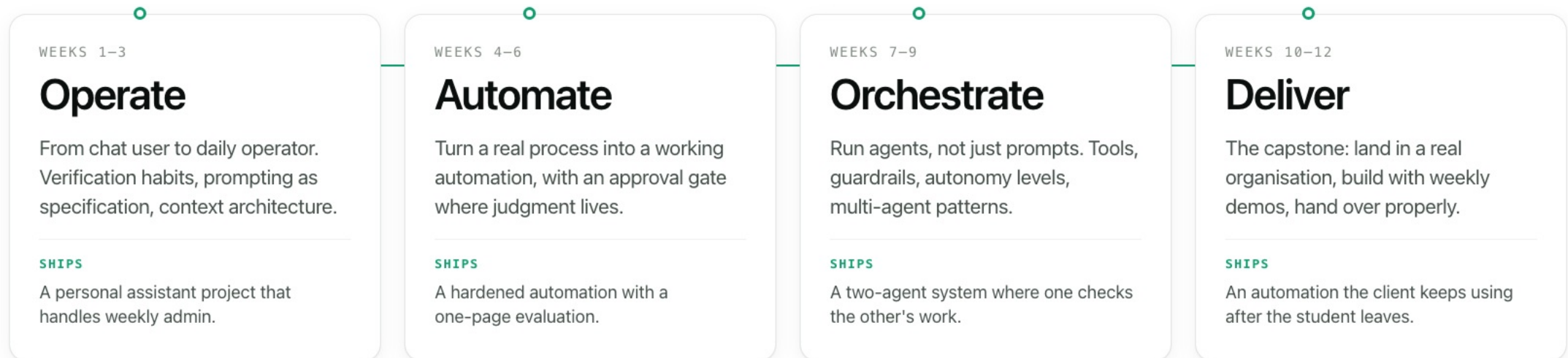
A graduate, dropped into an unfamiliar team, can within days:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 01 map the workflow as it actually happens today | 02 identify the steps worth automating, and the ones that are not |
| 03 architect the context an AI system needs: instructions, references, examples, data | 04 build the automation in stages |
| 05 choose the right autonomy level for each step | 06 measure before and after |
| 07 bring the people along | |

Agent orchestration is the headline skill. Judgment about when not to automate is part of the skill, not an afterthought.

— THE COURSE • TWELVE WEEKS, FOUR PHASES

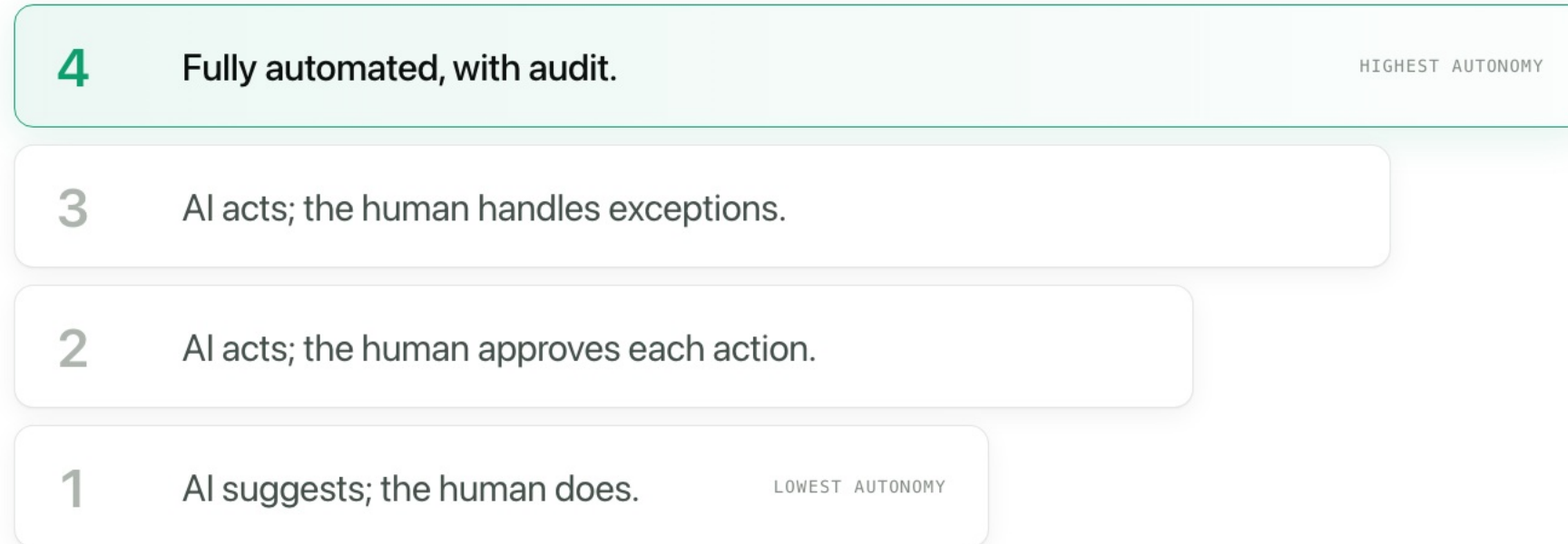
Two sessions a week. Every session ends with something built.



No exams. Assessment is a **public portfolio** plus a capstone panel. The capstone's standard of success is strict: the automation still in use after the student leaves.

— THE DISCIPLINE • TAUGHT EXPLICITLY, USED EVERY WEEK

The autonomy ladder.



Students justify the level they choose for **every step of every build**, and know how to move up and how to roll back. Verification is graded every week: each build carries a note on what was checked, and how.

— WHAT STUDENTS LEAVE WITH

Evidence an admissions officer or employer can click through, not a certificate of attendance.

01 A public portfolio of six or more working builds

Each with a measured before and after, and a note on what was checked and how.

03 Fluency on the toolset enterprises deploy

Concrete practice on Claude, Claude Code, and MCP connectors. The concepts transfer to any vendor.

Claude Code passed a \$2.5B run-rate; 8 of the Fortune 10 among 500+ firms spending over \$1M a year. Anthropic, Feb 2026 (company-reported).

02 A capstone a real organisation still uses

Delivered with a runbook and a trained owner, measured against the baseline agreed in week 10.

04 Free Anthropic Academy certificates

Collected along the way. The underlying AI Fluency framework is published under a Creative Commons licence.

WHO TEACHES IT

Njenga Kariuki

Managing Executive: Artificial Intelligence at M-Pesa Africa, leading AI transformation across Africa's largest fintech platform. He designed this course, and teaches both weekly sessions himself.

Born in Kenya, raised in the United States, returned in 2026. Coming home to build, and to train the next generation, is the point of the move.

100M+

customers on the platform whose AI transformation he leads at M-Pesa Africa, on \$2B+ in revenue.

12 years

at Amazon and AWS, building AI-native businesses and products from zero to one, across e-commerce, IoT, supply chain, health, and life sciences.

\$700M+

in P&Ls managed; delivered frontier machine learning, computer vision, and LLM capabilities at global scale, leading large science, engineering, and product organisations.

Stanford

GSB graduate, MS 2025, with published research from the Stanford Institute for Human-Centered AI: he co-wrote part of the evidence base this proposal cites.

— THE POSITION ON OFFER

As of June 2026, we found no published school-level programme anywhere with agent orchestration as its core outcome.

Our research synthesis across CodeAI, Khanmigo, OpenAI's certifications, Inspirit AI, and university-level agentic curricula, June 2026. Structured agentic-AI training appeared only at university and professional level. Your students would be early.

— WHAT THE PILOT NEEDS

A clear, contained pilot. Nothing presented as secured that is not.

COHORT

20 to 25 students, ages roughly 16 to 19, selected by the school.

INSTITUTIONAL AI ACCESS

Anthropic's consumer terms require users to be 18 or older, so under-18 students work through an institutional deployment with safeguards. Arranged by the school and instructor together; **not yet secured**. No partnership or endorsement is claimed.

THE INSTRUCTOR

Njenga teaches both weekly sessions himself for the full twelve weeks.

ROOM AND LAPTOPS

A lab with reliable power and internet, a laptop per student, twice a week.

FACULTY LIAISON

One named member of staff: safeguarding contact, capstone-client vetting, timetable owner.

DATES AND COST

[Term, 2026], scheduled around exam windows. **[Cost lines to be agreed]**. No figure is quoted because none has been agreed.

— THE NEXT STEP

The course is designed, the evidence base is verified, and the instructor is in Nairobi.

The proposed next step is a pilot cohort in [\[Term, 2026\]](#): a scoping conversation with leadership, the institutional access arrangement, student selection, and a named faculty liaison.



Njenga Kariuki

Managing Executive: Artificial Intelligence, M-Pesa Africa · [Preferred contact]

Every statistic in this proposal has a row in our claims register, with a source link verified on 12 June 2026.